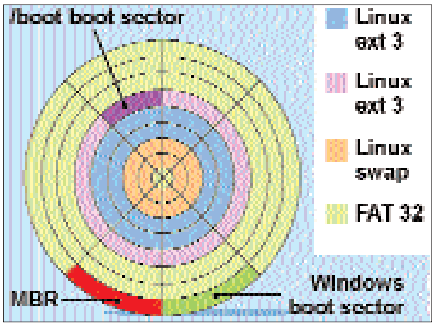
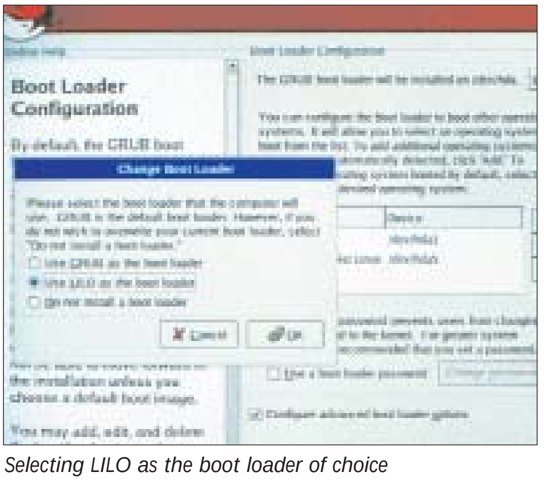
edit or delete the boot options for any OS. Click on 'Use boot loader password' to set a password at boot up. Even if you password protect your LILO, any user can still bot into Linux, but cannot change or even access any of LILO's advanced options, such as booting into single user mode.

Next, tick the 'Configure advanced boot loader options' checkbox. Here you can choose where to install LILO. Choose between installing LILO in the MBR (***/dev/hda*** for the master drive), or the first sector of the target partition (***/dev/hdaX***, where 'X' is the boot partition). If you intend to run a multi-boot system with Windows 98, go ahead with the default option and install the boot loader to the MBR.

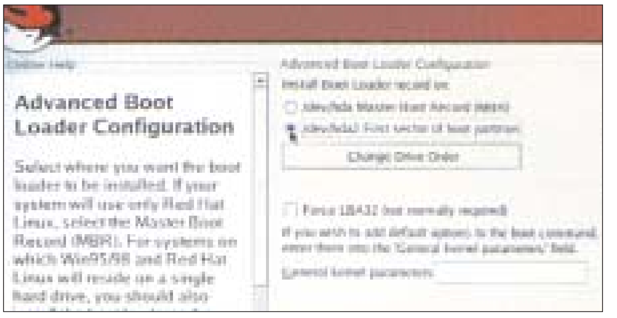


NTLDR was loaded into the MBR, and LILO was loaded on the boot sector (first sector) of the /boot partition. On booting up, the NTLDR is loaded into the memory and executed; if Windows is selected, the NTLDR loads the OS. When Linux is selected, the NTLDR passes control to LILO, and LILO then loads Linux

Of course, we loaded LILO ourselves to test everything out first-hand. The drive was partitioned for use with Windows XP (FAT32 file system) and Linux. The first partition (***/dev/hda1***) was set at 4.5 GB for Windows XP. Next, the ***/boot*** partition



Selecting LILO as the boot loader of choice



Getting LILO into the boot sector of the /boot partition

(***/dev/hda2***) was restricted to 80 MB, while the ***/*** or ***root*** partition (***/dev/hda5***) was set at 3 GB. The Linux swap partition (***/dev/hda3***) was set at about 350 MB.

Then, we installed Windows XP, and its boot loader (NTLDR) was automatically installed to the MBR. LILO was installed on the boot (first) sector of the ***/boot*** (***/dev/hda2***) partition—not on the MBR. This meant that NTLDR was left untouched, and LILO would not interrupt in its functioning. Similarly, if you happen to be using another boot loader—say if you happen to be running another Linux or Unix variant and would like to preserve the boot-up structure—choose to install LILO on the first sector of the ***/boot*** partition, and not on the MBR. Installing it on the MBR wipes out the original boot loader and renders the system incapable of booting into any operating system. Remember, if you've specified separate ***/boot*** and ***/(root)*** file system partitions whilst partitioning, LILO is installed to the first sector of the ***/boot*** partition, not the ***/(root)*** partition.

Leave the Force LBA32 option unchecked—modern systems don't need this. Add any parameters you want in the 'General kernel parameters' box—leave it empty if you don't know what you're doing—and you're done. In the screens that follow, you will go through the rest of the Linux installation procedure. If you've chosen to install LILO on the first sector of the boot partition (***/(root)*** or ***/boot***), you will have to make a boot diskette—LILO has not been installed on the MBR, so you will need to boot intoLinux through a boot diskette. The Red Hat installation program will prompt you to make one after all the software has been installed.

Boot it up

If you installed LILO on the MBR, you will be presented with a simple graphical boot menu that will allow you to choose the operating system to boot into. There is generally a 5-second timeout period—you can alter this later—after which the default operating system chosen at the time of installation is booted into. Although it's unlikely, if you face any problems with this, you can use the boot diskette to boot into Linux and make any changes to the LILO configuration. If you have installed LILO on the first sector of the boot partition, use the Linux boot diskette to boot into Linux.

With the default install of LILO, you should be able to boot into Windows 95 or 98 straight from LILO; however, Windows XP users will need to use the boot diskette. Remember, if you run Windows XP, and have installed LILO on the MBR, you will not be able to boot into XP through LILO—you'll get a fragmented 'L' appearing on the screen.

Smart boot

Once you've booted into Linux, you can change the way LILO works. Like many other Linux programs, LILO maintains a configuration file located at ***/etc/lilo.conf***. LILO reads the configuration file whilst booting to locate the necessary files.

The configuration file looks like this:

```
prompt
timeout=50
default=linux
boot=/dev/hda2
map=/boot/map
install=/boot/boot.b
message=/boot/message
lba32

image=/boot/vmlinuz-2.4.18-14
        label=linux
        initrd=/boot/initrd-2.4.18-14.img
        read-only
        append="root=LABEL=/"

other=/dev/hda1
        optional
        label=DOS
```

Any lines starting with a # are considered commented and are ignored by LILO.

Here, ***'timeout=50'*** indicates a timeout period of 5 seconds—change this to increase the timeout, such as 100 for 10 seconds.